



I WISH, IF ONLY



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Expemo code:

1BSJ-X648-D6BU



1

Presentation

We use **I wish ...** and **If only ...** when we regret something or when we would like something to be different than the way it is.

I wish I knew her name.

If only I knew her name.

(= *I don't know her name and I regret this.*)

After **I wish** and **if only**, we use a past tense (*I knew*) to refer to an imaginary or hypothetical situation in the present. The meaning is not past.

If only I had a bigger house. (*I don't have a big house now*)

I wish you **weren't** so angry all the time.

Do you wish you **lived** in another country?

When we regret something that happened in the past we use the structure **I wish / If only + past perfect**.

I wish you **had called** me yesterday.

If only you **had called** me yesterday.

(= *you didn't call me yesterday and I regret this*)

I wish I **hadn't gone out** last night.

If only you **had come** to my party last weekend.

Do you wish you **hadn't told** him?



Things to remember

- After **I wish** and **If only** we can say **were/weren't** instead of **was/wasn't**:

I **wish** I **was** home now.

I **wish** I **were** home now.

- If we wish something to be different in the future we can use **wish** or **if only** with **would**:

I wish he **would stop** talking!

- We can say **'d** instead of **had** or **would**:

I wish I **'d stayed** (= *had stayed*) at home.

I wish he **'d stop** (= *would stop*) talking.

- If only** is usually stronger than **I wish**.

Dialogue

A: I **wish** Tom **was** here. The party isn't the same without him.

B: But he's coming.

A: Ahh, **if only** you'd **told** me that earlier!

2

Practice 1

Look at the 'unpleasant' situations below. Write a sentence with 'I wish ...' like in the example.

- You don't live in a hot country. I wish I lived in a hot country.
- Your best friend isn't here.
- You are not tall enough.
- You can't sing.
- You don't have internet access.
- You are stuck in traffic.
- You don't have any coffee.
- You live in a noisy district.
- It is very cold today.





3

Practice 2 - Wish/If only + would

There are many situations in Mary's life which she would like to be different in the future. Read the situations below and complete her thoughts with 'would'/'wouldn't', using the following ideas.

not arrive late

stay at home

calm down

not eat junk food

stop arguing

turn down the music

quit his job

stop raining

use air conditioning

1. Her brother worries too much and gets emotional too easily. "I wish he would calm down."
2. The cafe where she goes to have a coffee and read a book is very loud.
"I wish they"
3. Her best friends can never agree on anything.
"If only they"
4. The office where she works is always very hot in the summer.
"I wish theyin the summer."
5. She often wants to go out, but the weather is usually bad.
"If only itso much!"
6. Her best friend has been complaining about his job for years.
"I wish he"
7. Her boyfriend goes out with his friends too much.
"I wish hemore often."
8. Her sister Kate has been putting on weight.
"If only sheall the time."
9. Her boyfriend is never on time.
"I wish heall the time."





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Practice 3 - Past regrets



Imagine that you are in the situations below and you regret them. Complete your thoughts:

1. You told your friend Mark about your secret. Now everybody knows.
"If only I hadn't told Mark about my secret."
2. You lost your credit card.
"I wish"
3. When you were younger, you didn't learn any foreign languages.
"I wish"
4. You invited your crazy friend Sam to your birthday party. That was a big mistake.
"If only"
5. You forgot to set your alarm clock. You woke up very late and missed an important meeting.
"I wish"
6. You ate too much and now you are feeling a little sick.
"I wish"
7. You did not study hard enough for your exams.
"If only"
8. You didn't lock your car. Somebody stole it.
"If only!"